



industry that's got its design language pretty set. Samsung's contender in this battle is a phone bolted to a camera – the Galaxy Zoom and the only cellphone camera that gives us proper optical zoom. So which of these is actually a good enough phone to replace that bulky point and shoot? Read on to find out.

The feature packer

All of the camera phones in this shootout are pricey, so it is imperative that you get the most photography related features you can. In our testing, we found that the Lumia 1020 packs the most features for a cellphone. This ranges from megapixel count, to sensor size, to optics, and even the battery life (if you're going to be shooting for long, you need a good battery!) The Lumia 1020 does pack the mother of all sensors, with 41 million pixels spread across a 1/1.15 inch sensor, the biggest in a modern day smartphone. It's also packing the optical image stabilization that we first saw in the Lumia 920, but switches out the spring based mechanism from the 920 (and 925) for a ball bearing based system.

Surprisingly, the Samsung Galaxy Zoom comes in at a close second, with an optical zoom capable lens (which is some-



Nokia Lumia 1020

what slow though) and shipping with multiple shooting modes, including P/S/M modes built into the default camera app. Other than that, it has some features very standard to the category it belongs, with other phones coming with a lot more. For example, we felt that the Sony Xperia Z1 had a pretty decent set of features, including a manual mode. The 1/2.3 inch sensor and the Sony G lens is something that we usually find in the company's point and shoot cameras such as the WX300 (which we liked quite a lot). It's got a mammoth 3000mAh battery too, to make

sure that you don't run out of juice on your shooting frenzy. The display on the Z1 is, if put bluntly, simply fantastic, rendering images in all their colourful glory. It is, however, not 100% accurate, being a TFT LCD type and not an IPS panel like in the Lumia 920.

Speaking of the Lumia 920, this is the phone that began



Nokia Lumia 920

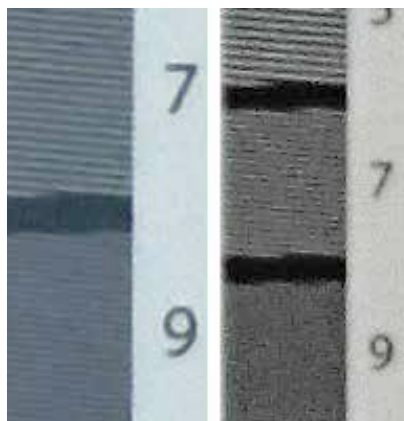
a new trend in mobile imaging by building an optical stabilization assembly right into the lens elements. The 920 packs a very gorgeous IPS display, which might not be incredibly saturated, but the colour and contrast rendition on it is absolutely accurate. The f/2.0 aperture on this is the brightest in the lot, meaning that the Lumia 920 lets in the most light of all the cameras in this shootout. However, the phone loses out to the fact that the 2000mAh battery built into it is somewhat underwhelming.

When considering features revolving around photography, it is impossible to ignore the LG G2, which also comes with

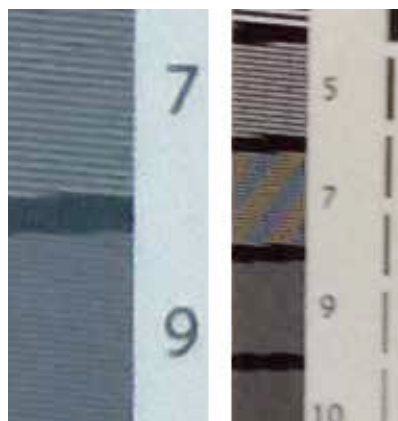


Nokia Lumia 925

optical image stabilization built into the lens. However, what really stands out is the power/shutter button that LG has removed from the usual side you'd find it on, and put it on the back. As unconventional as it may seem, the button is actually really well designed. Whether you're shooting "Selfies" or just taking shots using the rear camera, the button is incredibly easy to press and doesn't actually induce any shake, unlike other phones that have their shutter button on one extreme of the camera body. The HD+IPS panel is also beautiful and the camera itself has a pretty decent aperture of f/2.4



Lumia 1020s 41MP sensor on the left far outresolves the one on the Xperia Z1 right



Lumia 1020 resolves more lines per inch on the left than the iPhone 5's 8MP sensor right

The studio performer

Now going into this test, we had a pretty fair idea of which camera was going to come out on top, but what we did not know, was the rest of the order. The Lumia 1020 has a gigantic sensor (relatively, but still), not just in physical size, but also in the megapixel count. Factoring the size and the megapixel count, the effective pixel pitch on the camera drops to 1.12 μm ,